

Pictures, and Videos libraries. It also adds a new library, called Podcasts, to Windows 7. If you add content to any of these locations in Windows, it will automatically show up in Zune and, thus, can be synced with your Windows Phone. This stands in sharp contrast to Apple iTunes, which forces you to manually drag media from the file system into the application. That is, iTunes can't monitor folders throughout your file system automatically, as can Zune.

- ▶ **Marketplace:** This provides in-application access to Microsoft's online store for Zune and Windows Phone. And while Apple has nothing to fear quite yet the iTunes Store is still unassailable from a breadth of content perspective the Zune Marketplace (or Windows Phone Marketplace as it's sometimes called as well) offers a lot of content. This includes music, videos (music videos, TV shows, and movies), podcasts (which are free and come in both audio and video varieties), channels (the aforementioned 21st century radio stations that require a Zune Pass subscription), and mobile apps. Zune Marketplace, can be accessed both from the PC and via your Windows Phone. But there are some advantages to doing so from the PC. First, the onscreen real estate is dramatically more spacious on the PC, and this can lead to a better experience depending on what you're looking for. Second, not all of the Zune Marketplace content is available from your phone. When you're on the go, you can only browse for, and download, music and mobile apps. To get at the rest of the content in the store, you'll need to be on the PC.
- ▶ **Social:** Because the Zune services are connected to your Windows Live ID, you can connect the two and share your musical preferences with your friends. Those contacts you have in Windows Live that have also connected with Zune will show up in the Zune Social, which is Microsoft's online community for music lovers. From the Social interface in the Zune PC software, you can see your friends' recent music-related activities (that is, which artists, songs, and albums they've listened to most recently and most frequently), view your own musical history and preferences (and, in a cute move, view your badges, which act as the Achievements you'd get on Xbox Live, only this time for music, not games), and exchange messages with friends. Zune Marketplace, as accessed from the Zune PC software.